

THE GROWTH OF THE EU



1957 The Treaty of Rome is signed, establishing the European Economic Community (EEC), with six members.



1973 The Treaty of Accession: Denmark, Ireland, and the United Kingdom join the EU, giving nine member states.



1981 Greece becomes the 10th member of the EU. It had applied to join in 1975, after the restoration of its democracy.



1986 Spain and Portugal join the EU. The Single European Act is signed in 1987, aiming to create a single market.



1995 Austria, Finland, and Sweden join the EU, bringing membership of the EU up to 15 countries.

THE EUROPEAN UNION

FROM THE RUINS OF WAR, A CONTINENT UNITED

Europe emerged from World War II impoverished, war weary, and politically unstable. Born of a desire for peace and unity that would make another European war unthinkable, in 1957 six European countries joined in economic union. Since then, the European Union has grown substantially.

The modern age of the European Union (EU) began in 1987 with the Single European Act, an attempt to unify Europe further and create a "single market" for trade. The EU works toward increased cooperation in areas such as the environment, transportation, and employment. European citizenship and the introduction of the euro, a common currency, have made it easier to

work, travel, and do business with other member states, and the EU has become the largest economy in the world. Supporters of enlargement of the EU highlight this, and the benefits of political stability. Critics worry about immigration issues, the economic burden of supporting poorer countries, and the huge bureaucracy needed to run the organization.

17

THE NUMBER OF **COUNTRIES** WITH THE **EURO** AS THEIR OFFICIAL CURRENCY



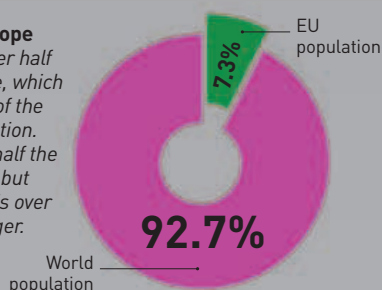
Ireland
GDP: \$172.3 billion
Population: 4,670,976



Portugal
GDP: \$247 billion
Population: 10,760,305

People of Europe

The EU has over half a billion people, which is 7.3 percent of the world's population. It is less than half the size of the US, but its population is over 50 percent larger.



3:4

City living

The EU has a mainly urban population, with 75 percent living in cities rather than in the countryside. By contrast, only around 45 percent of Africa's population lives in cities.

CHINA
1,340,000,000

Population comparison

The population of the EU is the world's third largest, after China and India.

INDIA
1,210,000,000

EU

501,000,000

“EUROPE IS THE FORCE THAT PREVENTS HATE FROM BEING ETERNAL. WE MUST OPEN OUR HEARTS TO THIS NEW EUROPE.”

Jean-Pierre Raffarin, French prime minister, 2004